An appreciable initiative has been the Government of India's 'offer of assistance of Rupees 500 crores for the relief, rehabilitation and resettlement of internally displaced persons belonging to the Tamil minority, and long-term reconstruction of the war-ravaged regions of the country.'[7] The military-to-military cooperation between our two countries has had to be nuanced and often done without publicity, keeping in mind the sensitivities involved. But below the surface, the defence relationship and military diplomacy have played an important role in building bridges between the two countries. A large number of officers and junior leaders of Sri Lanka's armed forces have been trained in India; now the military-to-military relationship can also be upgraded without the inhibitions of the past.

We share with Myanmar a land border of 1640 kilometres over thickly forested and rugged terrain where unfortunately a host of rebel organizations hold sway today. The areas to the west of the Chindwin river are extremely underdeveloped and can be more easily accessed from the Indian side. Taking advantage of the free trade regime upto 20 kilometres on both sides of the border, the Myanmarese Naga and other tribes depend heavily upon India and source everything from rations, medicines, kerosene, hardware and other necessities for day-to-day use from traders on our side of the border. It would be in the interest of both countries to open more trade routes and formalize the ongoing informal trade. The domain of defence cooperation has picked up considerably during the past six years or so. We need to work closely with the Myanmar army to eliminate the camps and safe havens created by the Indian terrorist organizations in the vicinity of the border. The need to launch coordinated operations on both sides of the border simultaneously to eliminate these camps is an imperative.

The ongoing defence cooperation between our nations is multifaceted and includes exchanges of visits, training, supply of military equipment, construction of goodwill roads in the border areas, and sharing of information and operations against Indian